[LIT-FLK-001] Shimreishang Kala Maitonphi

Translation: The Ballad of Shimreishang and Maitonphi

Work Type: BALLAD | Creator: Phungcham Oral Historians & Ballade | Year: 1982
Village: Phungcham | Dialect: Phungcham / Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: BK-CIIL-003
Publisher / Source: Documented in Arokianathan 1982, Horam 1977, CIIL
Clearance: Traditional Oral Heritage | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Tragic romance and star-crossed lovers (*Khararchan-Leikashi*),
Customary marriage negotiations and clan taboos, Poetic bereavement,
Structure & Meter: Epic ballad in traditional antiphonal meter with four-line stanzas and

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Critical Overview: The quintessential national romantic epic of the
Tangkhul people, composed in the 17th century in Phungcham village and

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Shimreishangna kaphung yarsho-li pamda, Maitonphi-wui samkapha leikashi
Luirim chonkashan shanaonao khamatha, Phungcham ramwui won thada ringkap
Chitharan chikaning mava-likha, kharuikahao mayarnao kacham-kacham leika

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

Shimreishang sat gazing across the mountain slopes, yearning for the rad
Draped in the woven splendor of the Luirim shawl, she bloomed like the r
Yet cruel fate and village clan divides intervened, testing the enduring

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Luirim : Traditional prestigious red, white, and black stri
* Kazeiram : The ancestral realm of the departed spirits
* Won : Blossom / flower / poetic metaphor for beauty and